

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 705

By Hensley

A RESOLUTION to recognize the Columbia Rotary Club's 250th anniversary of the United States celebration and the public reading of its Declaration of Reverence.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should join in commemorating significant milestones in our nation's history and honoring those civic organizations that inspire service, unity, and reflection within their communities; and

WHEREAS, the year 2026 marks the 250th anniversary of the founding of the United States of America, and across Tennessee, citizens are planning commemorative events to recognize this historic occasion and the enduring principles of liberty, justice, and representative government; and

WHEREAS, in observance of this milestone, the Columbia Rotary Club of Maury County will host a Fourth of July event at River Walk Park on July 4, 2026, offering an opportunity for citizens to come together in celebration, remembrance, and civic gratitude; and

WHEREAS, as part of its commemorative ceremony, the Columbia Rotary Club will present a 250th Anniversary Declaration of Reverence, reflecting the club's patriotic values and honoring the rich tradition of American service, community, and civic responsibility; and

WHEREAS, the full text of this Declaration of Reverence, as delivered by the Columbia Rotary Club, reads as follows:

On this July 4, 2026, We the People of Tennessee and the Legislative Body, declare a Declaration of Reverence and vow to uphold the Constitution of the United States of America, to represent those we serve, and to speak up for those who cannot speak for themselves. To recognize that governmental power originates and comes from the citizens as the ultimate source of authority, setting

aspirations for justice, welfare, and liberty for all. To recognize our nation's motto In God We Trust and to preserve the right to have this motto displayed in our public schools and public facilities.

To recognize the importance of protecting all the constitutional rights of law-abiding citizens and to encourage the pursuit of happiness and the American Dream. To recognize the rights of our law-abiding citizens to live a life that is free from discrimination and to empower our fellow citizens to stand firm that all ethnic groups and races are created equal and to be treated with respect. To recognize that knowledge is power and that all citizens have access to good public education, and to encourage advanced learning in our state colleges and vocational schools.

To recognize and empower our teachers and students with safe learning environments, to promote a drug-free learning environment, and to provide life skills training that will have continuing benefits for the rest of their lives. To recognize our law enforcement and first responders in the dangers they face and the sacrifices they make in the line of duty. To not forget the harsh realities that come from a service above self in the face of danger.

To recognize and honor our Tennessee National Guard and Military Reserves that work and serve in our community, and are on standby at a moment's notice to leave everything for the call of duty, and for our veterans who have served here and overseas. To recognize that military service during war can leave long-term consequences of the effects of war that may never leave them or their families, by supporting mental health services and reconnecting services to help them adjust to civilian life. To recognize the need for suicide

prevention efforts and education to be encouraged in our schools, workforce, military, and all citizens alike.

To recognize our charitable volunteers, churches, and nonprofit organizations who make our state a better place to live. To recognize our farming communities' agriculture and commerce, and to support and preserve our farming heritage. We the People of Tennessee and our Legislative Body, vow on this 250th anniversary of our nation's independence to live up to our state's mission to protect Tennesseans, empower professionals, and to love our great State of Tennessee.

WHEREAS, we acknowledge the Columbia Rotary Club's heartfelt expression of civic gratitude and patriotic reflection and commend the organization's commitment to honoring the 250th anniversary of the United States with this thoughtful and unifying declaration; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the Columbia Rotary Club for its 250th anniversary of the United States celebration and its presentation of the Declaration of Reverence and commend the club's efforts to foster civic pride, community unity, and thoughtful patriotism in the citizens of this State.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.

